

THE FRAMEWORK MAP

THE SCORE TAKES CARE OF ITSELF

Bill Walsh · *My Philosophy of Leadership* · 14 lessons, 5 movements

I THE STANDARD OF PERFORMANCE

01 The Standard of Performance

Champions behave like champions before they win.

02 Survive One Minute at a Time

When you're knocked down, stand up and start planning your next move.

II SUCCESS ISN'T SPELLED G-E-N-I-U-S

03 Making Lemonade Without Lemons

Great leadership is making lemonade when you don't even have lemons.

04 Control What You Can Control

When you prepare for everything, you're ready for anything.

III FUNDAMENTALS OF LEADERSHIP

05 Strength of Will, Right Reasons

A leader must never quit — and must know when to quit.

06 Sweat the Right Small Stuff

Don't mistake activity for achievement.

07 The Inner Voice and the Hard Edge

You determine what your team's inner voice says.

08 Teaching Defines Your Leadership

Big ears are better than big egos.

IV ESSENTIALS OF A WINNING TEAM

09 You're as Good as Your Good People

People are the heart of your organization.

10 Manage Confidence, Both Ways

You go down with a smile after winning big, just as surely as after losing.

11 Seek Character, Believe in People

Nobody will ever thank you for expecting too little of them.

V MASTERY & THE FINAL WORD

12 No Mystery to Mastery

The great leaders start learning young and never stop.

13 The Perfection of the Puzzle

The winners get more pieces of the puzzle in place than the losers.

14 Quick Results Come Slowly

Do all the right things to precision, and the score takes care of itself.

“Do all the right things to precision, and the score will take care of itself.”

— Bill Walsh

SET THE STANDARD. LEAD. MASTER THE GAME.

Walsh's philosophy on one page — pin it up, keep it close.

I SET THE STANDARD

Build the environment of excellence before you chase the win.

- **Write your Standard of Performance.**

Don't post a mission statement on the wall — define the concrete actions and attitudes you expect from every role, and implant them

- **Make the standard your prime directive.**

Point your people at the quality of execution, not the scoreboard. Return to the standard whenever things wobble; it's the compass

- **Model it yourself, visibly.**

You cannot demand actions and attitudes you don't personify. Roll up your sleeves, coach in the trenches, and let your own conduct be

- **Teach connection and extension.**

Show every person that their work is an extension of others' and that success — and failure — belongs to everyone. Independent

- **Expect defeat and plan to stand up.**

Setbacks are guaranteed. Allow brief grieving time, refuse to wallow, and channel your strength into planning the next move — one

II LEAD THE PEOPLE

Teach, communicate, and manage confidence in both directions.

- **Treat everyone right, regardless of rank.**

Afford equal dignity from superstar to receptionist. Treating people right — respect, family feeling, first-class treatment —

- **Make teaching your core act.**

Communicate with genuine enthusiasm, confirm your message is received and understood, and repeat it until execution is

- **Grow big ears.**

Set aside ego and truly listen. Invite input from everyone, ask good questions, and cure your own expert myopia with outside

- **Say 'I believe in you.'**

The four most powerful words a leader can say. Pair them with real teaching, and nurture people's belief in themselves — nobody ever

- **Keep a hard edge in reserve.**

Back your positive environment with a clear, occasionally demonstrated willingness to enforce consequences. People should feel

- **Immunize against Success Disease.**

When you're winning, hold the standard even higher and cultivate a one-point-underdog mentality. Complacency rots a champion as

III MASTER THE GAME

Innovate, prepare, and — hardest of all — release the score.

- **Make lemonade without lemons.**

Study what you actually have and build a system around real strengths, turning so-called limitations into uncommon assets.

- **Script your future.**

War-game contingencies before they arrive so panic never gets a vote. Distinguish the ~20 percent you can't control from the ~80

- **Persist — for the right reasons.**

Be unswerving once you've evaluated the information, but interrogate why you persist. Trying to prove you're right, or someone else

- **Sweat the right small stuff.**

Pursue the details that actually drive performance; notice when you're 'sharpening pencils' to dodge the hard problems you're

- **Make your own mentors and get your mind right.**

Learn aggressively from everyone, official mentor or not, and build a pre-performance ritual that clears worry and distraction so you

- **Do the work to precision — then let go.**

Prepare your organization completely, refuse to tie your worth to the scoreboard, don't isolate yourself, delegate abundantly, and